

A Choice That Has a Cost: The Trial Run

有代价的选择：第一次试行

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The trial run began with a **limited prospect** and a **heated** argument about the **heat** itself: could a **beautiful** old building be made cool without being ruined? “I **suggest** we test two rooms and let the results **occur**,” Lin said. “We **intend** to do a real **evaluation**, not a **prediction**.” The **feeling** in the room was that the issue would **embarrass** them both.

The **passion** of the meeting was genuine and the **accuracy** of the numbers was not. “We have too much **expectation** and too little **sensitivity**,” the engineer said. “A **wealthy** client will **opt** for the **outward** look; a poor tenant will **perceive** the **inward** cost.” The five of them had, probably, two months and one chance.

The **possibility** of a **postponement** arrived with the first cold night. “Yesterday the plan was **obvious**, and **tomorrow** it will be **scandalous**,” the director said. “We underestimated the **vigor** of the winter, and we let the hope of a quick fix **madden** us.”

The **disgust** that followed was not **intentional**; it came from a bad measurement. “You can **explode** with **passion** and still be wrong,” Maya wrote. “**Happiness** is not a design criterion, and **goodness** is not a discount.” The **inward** and the **outward** temperature had been recorded twenty times, and the history of the building had been read only once.

“How do we **waken** the council without overwhelming it?” the engineer asked. “**Damn** the schedule; a two-week delay is better than a scandal.” The **sensitivity** of the sensor, the **accuracy** of the survey, and the real cost of the work were all, **yet** again, in the same unhappy column.

The trial run ended with a small, useful result and one new constraint: the group would have to be **awake** to the difference between what they **deem** true and what they can prove. The choice that had a cost was the choice to publish the weak number first. Although we believe in the plan, the order of the moment is to try a smaller version, because a **passionate** and **dramatically** wrong forecast is not **foresight**. A promise can **bind** two people without binding the outcome, and a kind fall is still a fall.

中文翻译

试行以一个有限的前景和一场关于热本身的激烈争论开始：一座美丽的老建筑能否在不被毁掉的前提下变凉？“我建议我们测两个房间，让结果自己发生，”林伟说，“我们打算做一次真正的评估，而不是一个预测。”屋里的感觉是：这个问题会让他们两人都难堪。

会议的热情是真诚的，而数字的准确性不是。“我们有太多期待，太少敏感度，”工程师说，“富有的客户会选外表的观感；贫穷的租客会感知内在的代价。”他们五个人大概有两个月时间和一次机会。

延期的可能性随着第一个寒夜到来。“昨天这个方案还是显而易见的，明天它就会是丑闻，”主管说，“我们低估了冬天的活力，也让“快速修复”的希望把我们逼疯了。”

随之而来的厌恶不是故意的；它来自一次糟糕的测量。“你可以满怀热情地爆发，仍然出错，”曼雅写道，“快乐不是一项设计标准，善良也不是一个折扣。”室内和室外的温度被记录了二十次，而这栋建筑的历史只被读过一次。

“我们如何在不压垮委员会的前提下唤醒它？”工程师问。“管它什么日程；两周的延误好过一桩丑闻。”传感器的灵敏度、调查的准确性，以及工程的真实成本，又一次全都落在同一个不幸的栏目里。

试行以一个小小的有用结果和一条新的约束结束：小组必须清醒地看到他们“认为”为真与“能够证明”之间的差别。有代价的选择，是先公开那个难看的数字。虽然我们相信这个计划，但此刻的次序是先试一个更小的版本，因为一份热情而又错得离谱的预报不是远见。一个承诺可以把两个人绑在一起，却绑不住结果，而一次温和的跌倒仍然是跌倒。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
yet jet POS: adv	adv. 还, 尚, 仍然, 已经, 然而; conj. 然而 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. up to the present time; r. within an indefinite time or at an unspecified future time
suggest səg'dʒest POS: vt	vt. 提议, 建议, 促成, 暗示, 启发, 使人想起; [法] 建议, 提出, 提议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. imply as a possibility; v. call to mind
occur ə'ke: POS: vi	vi. 发生, 被想到, 存在 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come to one's mind; suggest itself; v. to be found to exist
feeling 'fi:lɪŋ POS: n	n. 摸, 触觉, 知觉, 感觉, 情绪, 同情; a. 有同情心的, 有感觉的, 仁慈的, 动人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the experiencing of affective and emotional states; n. a physical sensation that you experience; n. an intuit...
intend in'tend POS: vt	vt. 计划, 打算, 意思是; [法] 想要, 打算, 意旨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have in mind as a purpose; v. design or destine
beautiful 'bjʊ:tɪfʊl POS: a	a. 美丽的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. delighting the senses or exciting intellectual or emotional admiration; s. (of weather) highly enjoyable
heat hi:t POS: n	n. 热, 热度, 体温, 高潮; vi. 加热, 激昂, 加剧; vt. 把...加热, 使激动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form of energy that is transferred by a difference in temperature; n. the sensation caused by heat energy...
possibility ,psə'bɪləti POS: n	n. 可能性, 可能的事; [法] 可能性, 可能发生的事, 不确定权 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a future prospect or potential; n. capability of existing or happening or being true; n. a possible alternat...
tomorrow tə'mɔ:rəu POS: n	n. 明天, 未来; adv. 明天, 未来地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the day after today; n. the near future; r. the next day, the day after, following the present day
obvious 'ɒbvɪəs POS: a	a. 明显的, 明白的, 显然的, 平淡无奇的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. easily perceived by the senses or grasped by the mind
limited 'lɪmɪtɪd POS: a	a. 有限制的, 有限的, 有限责任的; n. 特别快车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. small in range or scope; s. including only a part; s. mediocre; s. not excessive
prospect 'prɒspekt POS: n	n. 景色, 展望; vt. 勘探, 勘察; vi. 勘探, 有前途 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the possibility of future success; v. search for something desirable; v. explore for useful or valuable thin...
bind baɪnd POS: vt	vt. 绑, 约束, 装订, 包扎, 使结合; vi. 凝固, 有约束力; [计] 赋值, 绑定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that hinders as if with bonds; v. create social or emotional ties; v. make fast; tie or secure, wi...
expectation ,ekspek'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 期待, 指望, 展望; [化] 期望值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. belief about (or mental picture of) the future; n. the feeling that something is about to happen
perceive pə'si:v POS: vt	vt. 感觉, 认知, 理解, 意识到 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to become aware of through the senses; v. become conscious of
passion 'pæʃən POS: n	n. 激情, 酷爱, 热爱, 强烈感情, 耶稣受难(故事) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong feeling or emotion; n. a feeling of strong sexual desire; n. the suffering of Jesus at the Crucifix...
evaluation i.vælju'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 评估, 估价, 求值; [计] 鉴定; 评价; 求值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. act of ascertaining or fixing the value or worth of; n. an appraisal of the value of something
wealthy 'welθɪ POS: a	a. 富有的, 富裕的, 充分的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s having an abundant supply of money or possessions of value
explode ɪk'spləʊd POS: vi	vi. 爆炸, 爆发, 激增; vt. 使爆炸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to burst with a violent release of energy; v. burst outward, usually with noise; v. show a violent emo...
dramatically drə'mætɪkli POS: adv	adv. 戏剧地, 引人注目地, 突然地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a very impressive manner; r. in a dramatic manner; r. with respect to dramatic value
prediction prɪ'dɪkʃən POS: n	n. 预言, 预报; [化] 预测 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of predicting (as by reasoning about the future); n. a statement made about the future
opt ɒpt POS: vi	vi. 选择 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v select as an alternative over another

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
happiness 'hæpinɪs POS: n	n. 快乐, 幸运, 适当 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. state of well-being characterized by emotions ranging from contentment to intense joy; n. emotions experien...
accuracy 'ækjʊərəsi POS: n	n. 精确, 正确; [计] 准确度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being near to the true value; n. (mathematics) the number of significant figures given in a...
sensitivity 'sensetɪvɪti POS: n	n. 敏感, 灵敏度; [计] 灵敏度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (physiology) responsiveness to external stimuli; the faculty of sensation; n. the ability to respond to phy...
deem di:m POS: v	v. 认为, 相信 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. keep in mind or convey as a conviction or view
goodness 'gʊdnɪs POS: n	n. 仁慈, 善良 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n that which is pleasing or valuable or useful; n moral excellence or admirableness
damn dæm POS: n	n. 一点, 诅咒, 丝毫; interj. 该死, 该死的; vt. 诅咒, 罚...下地狱; vi. 指责, 谴责, 骂...该死, 证明... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something of little value; s. used as expletives
awake ə'weɪk POS: a	a. 醒着的; vt. 唤醒, 唤起, 使意识到; vi. 醒来, 被唤起, 意识到 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not in a state of sleep; completely conscious
overwhelm ,əuvə'hwelɪm POS: vt	vt. 淹没, 受打击, 制服, 压倒, 使不知所措; [法] 打翻, 倾覆, 覆盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. overcome, as with emotions or perceptual stimuli; v. charge someone with too many tasks
passionate 'pæʃənɪt POS: a	a. 热情的, 热烈的, 易怒的, 热恋的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or expressing strong emotions
underestimate ,ʌndə'restɪmeɪt POS: n	n. 低估; vt. 低估, 看轻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an estimation that is too low; an estimate that is less than the true or actual value; v. make too low an e...
heated 'hi:tɪd POS: a	a. 热的, 激昂的, 兴奋的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. made warm or hot ('het' is a dialectal variant of 'heated'); s. marked by emotional heat; vehement
embarrass ɪm'bærəs POS: vt	vt. 使困窘, 使局促不安, 阻碍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious
disgust dɪs'gʌst POS: n	n. 厌恶, 嫌恶; vi. 令人厌恶; vt. 使作呕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. strong feelings of dislike; v. fill with distaste; v. cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of
inward 'ɪnwəd POS: a	a. 内心的, 向内的, 本来的; [医] 向内的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or existing in the mind or thoughts; r. toward the center or interior
outward 'aʊtwəd POS: a	a. 向外的, 表面的, 外服的; adv. 向外, 在外, 表面 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to physical reality rather than with thoughts or the mind; r. toward the outside
intentional ɪn'tenʃənəl POS: a	a. 故意的, 与目的有关的; [法] 故意的, 有意的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by conscious design or purpose
vigor 'vɪɡə POS: n	n. 精力, 活力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. active strength of body or mind
madden 'mædn POS: vt	vt. 使发狂, 激怒; vi. 发狂, 发怒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to go crazy; cause to lose one's mind; v. drive up the wall; go on someone's nerves; v. make mad
postponement pəʊst'pəʊnmənt POS: n	n. 延迟, 延期; [法] 延期, 延迟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. act of putting off to a future time
foresight 'fɔ:sait POS: n	n. 远见, 深谋远虑; [法] 预见, 预见的能力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. providence by virtue of planning prudently for the future
scandalous 'skændələs POS: a	a. 不体面的, 可耻的, 诽谤性的, 爱传播丑闻的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation
waken 'weɪkn POS: vt	vt. 唤醒, 使觉醒, 激发; vi. 觉醒, 醒来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v cause to become awake or conscious; v stop sleeping